Harkha Bai Kachhwaha (1542–1623): Akbar's first Rajput wife, mother of Salim, daughter of Raja Bharmal, and aunt of Raja Man Singh. Brought Rajput traditions into the Mughal harem. Survived Akbar and was known by her title Maryam uz Zamani.

Kuar (later Raja) Man Singh (1550–1614): Son of Bhagwant Das. A favourite of Akbar's, who called him farzand (son). Became one of the highest noblemen of the empire, with a mansab of 7,000. Defeated Rana Pratap at the Battle of Haldighati. Instrumental in subduing Bengal, Orissa, and Bihar. Great patron of architecture—built the Govardhan Temple in Mathura and Rohtas Fort in Bihar.

Man Bai (1570–1604): Daughter of Bhagwant Das. Named Shah Begum after her marriage to Prince Salim. Khusrau's mother.

COURTIERS

Tansen (1500–1586): Musician from Gwalior who was called to Akbar's court. Akbar's favourite musician, composer of many lyrics in Brajbhasha.

Shaikh Mubarak (1505-1593): Father of Abu'l Fazl and Faizi. A man of great learning and religiosity. Initially an orthodox theologian, he later became attracted to Sufism and the ideas of the Mahdavis. Joined Akbar's court in 1573 and was instrumental in introducing the Padshah to the ideas of scholar and philosopher Ibn Arabi, amongst others.

Raja Birbal (1528–1586): Hindu courtier and great favourite of Akbar. Often distinguished by personal marks of favour by Akbar. A talented poet, he held the title Kavi Rai. Died during the Yusufzai campaign in 1586, and was deeply mourned by the Padshah. The only Hindu to become a disciple of Akbar's sulh kul.

Abd al-Qadir Badauni (1540–1605): Mughal courtier and orthodox Sunni Muslim, Badauni was highly disapproving of Akbar's religious policies and wrote a covert, critical biography of Akbar's reign. He was also the most prolific translator of Akbar's ateliers, participating in the translation of various works from Sanskrit to Persian, including the Mahabharat and the Ramayan.

Abu'l Fazl (1551–1602): Son of Shaikh Mubarak, Abu'l Fazl was a brilliant scholar educated primarily by his father. He joined Akbar's court in